

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills to listen to customer needs and explain treatments clearly.



Creativity and artistic ability to keep up to date with new techniques and styles.



Strong customer service skills for interacting with people and making them feel comfortable.



Excellent manual dexterity to apply beauty treatments, such as skin-care products and makeup.



Physical stamina for standing for long periods of time while giving customers their treatments.



Precision and attention to detail for applying makeup and other treatments neatly and accurately.



NAIL TECHNICIAN Carries out manicures and pedicures and applies lotions, varnishes, and artificial nails. Nail technicians may also offer other treatments, such as foot massage.



HAIR REMOVAL SPECIALIST Uses a variety of techniques, such as electrolysis, waxing, threading, or laser treatment, to remove unwanted hair from clients.



COSMETICS CONSULTANT Visits salons, beauticians, and stores to demonstrate and sell new beauty products and treatments.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **MAKEUP ARTIST** *see pp. 32–33*
- ▶ **HAIRDRESSER** Cuts, colors, shapes, and styles hair, and gives advice on suitable and attractive styles for individual clients. Hairdressers need good people skills in order to build long-term relationships with clients, as well as an awareness of style trends and a willingness to learn new methods of hairstyling.
- ▶ **IMAGE CONSULTANT** Offers advice to individual clients on their public image, including makeup styles, clothing and dress, and personal presentation. Image consultants also advise companies and corporations on a vast range of topics—such as branding, business etiquette, and understanding corporate culture.

AT A GLANCE



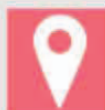
YOUR INTERESTS Beauty treatments and techniques • Health and fitness • Customer service • Art • Design • English • Fashion



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Cosmetologists can train on the job, but a vocational qualification is required by most employers.



LIFESTYLE Most cosmetologists work regular hours, but working during weekends or evenings may occasionally be required.



LOCATION This job can be done in a beauty salon, hotel, health spa, or on a cruise ship. Some cosmetologists visit clients in their own homes.



THE REALITIES The work involves close physical contact with clients, which may be uncomfortable. Strong competition means that salaries are low.